Charting a Visionary New Course for Tourism in GOA



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Hon'ble Minister for Tourism, IT, E &C, Printing & Stationery, Government of Goa talks about the initiatives being undertaken in Goa to develop tourism in Goa to greater heights.

WHAT IS YOUR VISION FOR TOURISM IN GOA?

Goa is a preferred destination for tourism and it is evolving to meet the new and higher expectations of the tourists, so for the last year we have been exploring new opportunities and thought processes to improve our tourism product. We are focussing on infrastructure, policy, developing new destinations and supporting the Prime Minister's vision of 'Dekho Apna Desh'. We are also in the process of putting in programmes and policies to make Goa the creative capital of India.

WHAT NEW EXPERIENCES AND DESTINATIONS CAN VISITORS TO GOA LOOK FORWARD TO?

By default, Goa has been a 'sun, sea and sand' destination but in fact it has a lot more to offer. Apart from Goa's Portuguese culture, we also have numerous temples, including the Saptakoteshwar and Mangeshi temples. Some of the temples date back to 1,000 years. There's a large concentration of temples in Ponda. Our villages are very beautiful. We are also looking at ecotourism, wellness tourism, nautical tourism, adventure and spirituality. Our post-COVID learning tells us that tourist want more experiential and immersive experience. Initiatives like home stay and caravan tourism will give the tourist an opportunity to explore Goa beyond the beaches. Since Goa is unique with two active airports, we envisage a large influx of Tourist in state. Hence, we are working on several projects in state like on themes wellness, eco tourism. Hinterland etc.

Goa has been known as land created by Lord Parashurama and to pay homage we are going to create related attractions.

Goa known to land of festivals including apart from well-known festivals like Shigmo and the Carnival we have many festivals throughout the year and we want tourists to come for those as well. Goa is also the foodie capital of India now.

WHAT OVERSEAS MARKETS ARE YOU FOCUSSING ON?

Apart from our traditional markets like the UK, Russia, Germany we are also looking at markets of USA, UAE and certain key markets in South East Asia. We are also looking at the UAE in a big way. We are in process of increasing room capacity since we forsee an increase in room demand.

To attract digital nomads in Goa we will offer them relevant infrastructure in the form of spaces where they can work and relax. These sea hubs or tourism hubs along the beach will provide all the service utility and also provide excess to attractions of culture and other events around the geographical eco system. To facilitate this we are closely working with centre too.

Similarly, people who come for a long stay would normally want to opt for homestays, so we are soon to launch a homestay policy. We are drafting state's heritage policy whereby a lot of the old houses will be made open for tourists for immersive experiences.

HOW WILL THE NEW MOPA AIRPORT HELP BOOST TOURISM IN THE STATE?

Mopa does not have the restrictions. This will open lot of possibilities for air travel to and from Goa. Both domestic and international carriers see Goa as a preferred destination to fly into, and those opportunities are being explored for maximum benefits to state. We are connecting Goa with rest of India and as part of our initiative towards PM vision of Dekho Apna Desh we have signed an MOU with Uttrakhand recently. We have already moved on Tier-2 cities like Nagpur, Nasik, Guwahati, Amritsar and Varanasi too for direct air connectivity.